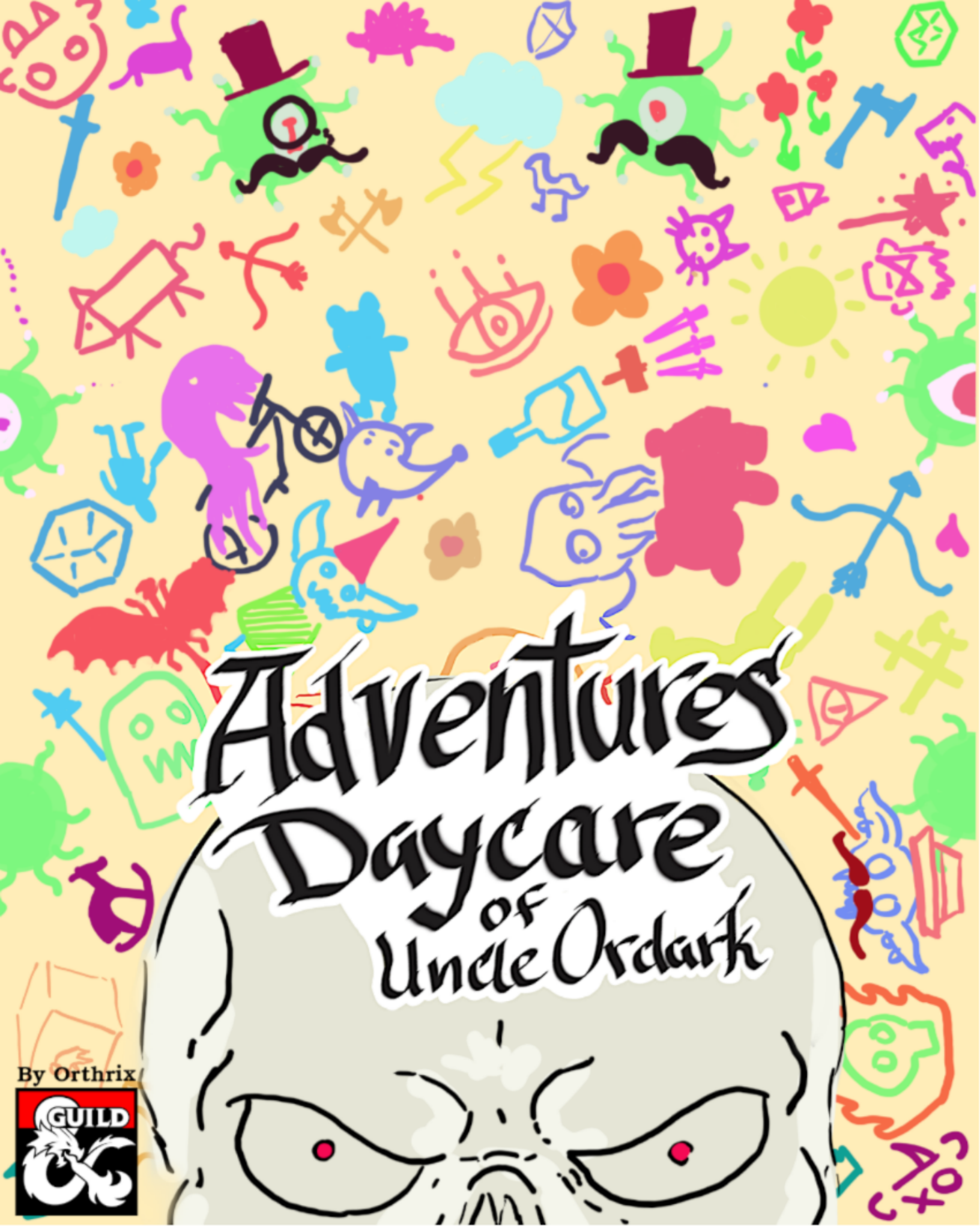

Adventures
Daycare
of
Uncle Ordark
By Orthrix
GUILD

Adventures Daycare of Uncle Ordark

by Orthrix

DUNGEONS & DRAGONS, D&D, Wizards of the Coast, Forgotten Realms, Ravenloft, the dragon ampersand, and all other Wizards of the Coast product names, and their respective logos are trademarks of Wizards of the Coast in the USA and other countries.

This work contains material that is copyright Wizards of the Coast and/or other authors. Such material is used with permission under the Community Content Agreement for Dungeon Masters Guild.

All other original material in this work is copyright 2022 by Orthrix and published under the Community Content Agreement for Dungeon Masters Guild.

Contents

Ch. 1: Adventures Daycare 1
Introduction 1
Play as a kid 1
Ch. 2: The house 3
Attic 3
First floor 4
Basement 6
Ch. 3: Outside the house 7
Ch. 4: Appendix 8

Chapter 1: Adventures Daycare

Introduction

Once famous champion Ordark, who slew the Lich King and single-handedly defeated the dragon conclave (he couldn't have done it any other way, as he only has one arm), is now retired. That doesn't stop him from new endeavours such as establishing "Adventures Daycare of Uncle Ordark", where he takes care of his fellow adventurers' children. Some just need him to watch over their children while they travel across the planes and assassinate gods. Others unfortunately demised and left their offspring alone. No matter how they got to his daycare, Uncle Ordark will take care of them. His idea of a daycare might be closer to the training camp of the elite Thay legion, but where else would these kids find a loving home and secure place to stay? Whether they will use their acquired skill to conquer the world or save it, Uncle Ordark will be proud of them.

The players take the roles of Ordark's proteges around age 4-5 and will embark on a quest to investigate Ordark's disappearance.

Story synapse

After Ordark puts the kids to bed, he is surprised by the sudden visit of his ex-wife Talaryl Dalach. They argue but realise that there is still something between them and reforge the heat of their love right there on the floor. That might have been a little louder than they wanted, and Ordark is scared they would wake the kids. So he takes a few bottles of his best liquor and a food basket, and then they head into the night.

Ordark Blood Fist is a giant of a half-orc in his late 60s. His light green skin with greyish shades is adorned by numerous tattoos and scars. His left arm is missing from the elbow, but it doesn't seem to slow him down in any activity. In retirement, Ordark is 11th-level Barbarian and 9th-level Cleric with access to Raise Dead.

Taraly Dalach is a world-class assassin. She is a drow and was raised to be a personal bodyguard to the church of Spider Queen. After she met Ordark, she left Underdark, travelled the world, and built a name for herself as one of the best assassins. One day she met Ordark again as a guard to one of her marks. After she made him unemployed, they got married and fought side by side for several years.

The Kids are a mixed bag of orphans and kids left in Ordark's care as their parents headed into danger. They are not ordinary children but children of well-known adventurers and heroes, so they often attract the attention of assassins sent by revengeful foes of their parents or kidnapper seeking hefty ransoms. Nothing that Ordark cannot easily defeat without kids even noticing.

Adventure Hook

> Uncle Ordark tells his children a bedtime story about his exploits in the Underdark: "...and I jumped into the pond with the Elder Brain, and I started to pummel it with my fist. When it realised that it could not get in my noggin as I was filled with ANGER and RAGE, it panicked and tried to strangle me with its tiny, puny tendrils. But my neck is too thick for that! Ha, ha, ha. So I split it into one artistic elder brain and one very logical, but both very much dead. Ha ha. I couldn't get rid of the brainy smell for months! Now it's time to sleep, my little warriors and remember Uncle Ordark loves you above all else" he kisses their foreheads, tucks them into the bed, dims the lantern, locks the door and slowly descends the stairs stepping gingerly to make the least amount of sound.

In the middle of the night, more perceptive kids are woken by a sudden ruckus downstairs. Muffled voices can be heard arguing about something. Kids can try to see what is happening through a hole in the floor. A high perception check reveals that there are two figures. One is Ordark, and the other figure is smaller in a dark cloak. They shout at each other, and it seems they start to fight and struggle over something. Ordark seems to lose balance and falls to the ground, grappled by a smaller figure. They continue to "fight" and roll out of sight. Kids can hear furniture breaking and screams and groan like someone is being tortured down there. After a few minutes, it stops, and all they can hear is the sound of broken glass and the front door opening and closing.

Play as a kid

Each player should create a regular 3rd-level character of any race and class. All characters are children aged 1d3+2, no taller than 40 inches; their movement is halved. At the start of the adventure, they should have no equipment, only simple clothes. The fact that characters are still small children should be considered when deciding on the Difficulty Classes (DC) of a challenge. Even simple tasks can prove to be difficult. For example: moving an armchair to the window is a strength check with DC 15.

Kids cannot read, but they remember some

descriptions and labels Ordark showed them. Additionally, each player is randomly assigned one positive and one negative kid trait and one legendary item.

Positive traits

Sugar rush	**As an action you can consume sweets, granting you effects of spell Haste (see pg. Basic Rules).**
Bookworm	You cannot read per se, but you are pretty good with colours, shapes, and animal sounds. Advantages on intelligence-based checks.
Not fully formed bones	Your body is still squishy. You gain resistance to bludgeoning damage, and all fall damage is halved.
No concept of death	The idea of death is utterly foreign to you, rendering you immune to being frightened.
Curious mouth	You spend the better part of the day chewing, sucking and licking various things you find on the ground, rendering you resistant to poison and having an advantage to constitution saves.
Feral	As a bonus action, you can use a bite attack (1d4 piercing damage)

Each player gets one legendary item.

Teddy-owlbear

Wondrous item, rare

Renderers holder immune to being frightened and grants +1 to AC. For effect to apply, it must be held offhand instead of a shield.

Hobby horse

Wondrous item, rare

Twice per short rest, you can use Hobby horse to take the Disengage or Dash Action as a bonus Action on your turn, and your jump distance is doubled for the turn.

Kaleidoscope

Wondrous item, rare

While in use, grants Truesight to the user, but everything looks like an oversaturated cubist painting.

A bag of colourful buttons

Wondrous item, rare

As an action, a handful of buttons can be tossed into the air. Any creature that sees the buttons has to make a Wisdom save or spend their turn admiring the colours. Once a creature saves, it is immune to the effect.

Pet rock

Wondrous item, rare

Throwing weapon 1d8 bludgeoning damage. On the hit, the target has to save against Constitution save DC 10 or be stunned till the start end of its turn.

Negative traits

Big-headed	**Your head is disproportionately larger than your body. You have a disadvantage on all athletic and acrobatic checks and saves, and your movement is halved again.**
Sleepyhead	If you haven't attacked or been attacked during one round of combat, you will fall asleep, and other players need to spend their action to wake you up.
Hatred towards clothes	There is nothing you hate more than being dressed in uncomfortable clothes. At the start of the combat, roll d20 to determine whether you managed to undress before combat (10 or lower means you start combat naked). You can use an action on your turn to dress again.
Tantrum!	When you fail a skill check or miss an enemy, you must save Charisma saving throw DC 10 or spend your next turn having a tantrum.
Eloquent talker	You cannot form complex sentences, and the maximum number of words in a sentence is 5.
Wanderer	At the start of the combat, roll 1d6 x 5ft to determine how far you are from the enemy and 1d4 to determine in which direction (North, West, East, South).

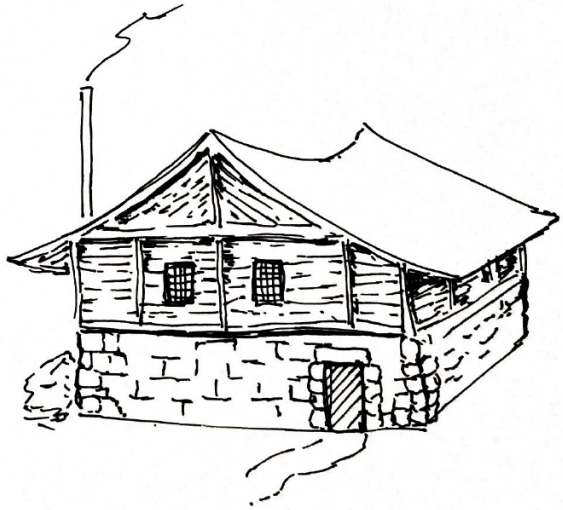
Chapter 2: The house

Kids start the adventure in the attic and need to get to the basement, crawl through the window into the garden and follow Ordark's steps.

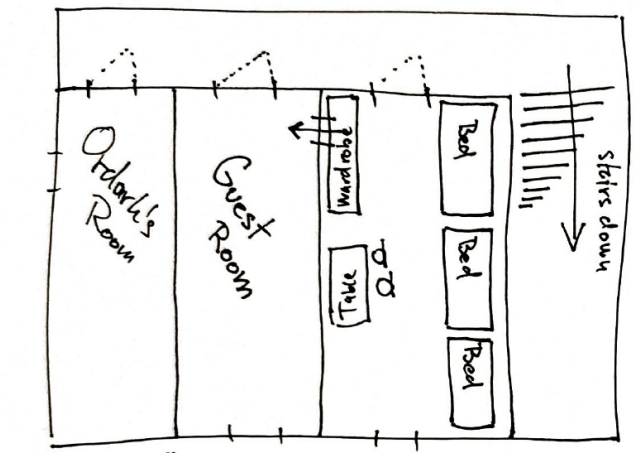
While kids stayed in Odarks care, they could move around the house freely. Still, these parts were off limits: basement, guest room, Ordarsk study, Ordarsk bedroom, kitchen and backyard.

All doors in the house are heavy wooden doors with iron reinforcement. The house's walls are stone, and the second floor and roof are made entirely from wood.

The house itself has 2 floors and a basement. Around the house is a lush garden with a white gazebo and a small pond in the middle.



Attic



Kids' room

A simply adorned room with three bunk beds, one old wardrobe, chest, a small table, a couple of stools and plenty of toys scattered around the floor.

The walls are decorated by poorly painted forest critters, small birds, flowers and an occasional beholder with a moustache and a hat or an aboleth riding a bicycle. It seems like Ordark painted it himself. There is one barred window with a view of the backyard. The door is locked.

Searching the room:

- In the middle of the room, among other toys (plush dragons, ragdoll hill giants, . . .) is a **wooden longsword**, a helmet made out of a pumpkin, and a **wooden axe**.
- Under one of the bunk beds is a suitcase. Inside is a **wooden longsword, small shield, toy wooden bow with 15 arrows, a sling, and a bag of marbles**.
- The chest is not locked but needs a strength check DC 15 to open. Inside is a wand with a pink start at the end and a **key to the wardrobe**.
- The wardrobe is locked. Inside are two child-sized **leather jackets** and a small hole leading to the **Guest room**.
- On the table is a picture book about nature and animals, illustrating different concepts: above water is a mountainside, above clouds, and from the clouds, a smiling sun is showing. Fish live in the water, wolves live in the mountains, birds live in the clouds (someone drew Cloud giants next to the birds), and gods live among stars.

Wooden longsword

common item

1d8 slashing, versatile, on a critical hit, roll 1d3 for additional splinter damage.

Toy wooden bow,

common item

1d8 piercing, two-handed, range 40/80

Small shield

common item

AC + 2.

Bag of marbles

common item

See Ball bearings.

Wand of a pink star

common item

Wand with a pink start at the end requires attunement, can be used as a spellcasting focus and once a day can be used to cast Tasha's hideous laughter.

Wooden axe

common item

Wooden axe, 1d6 can be thrown range 20/40, critical hit on 19/20 and on critical hit roll 1d3 for additional splinter damage.

Leather jackets

common item

AC 14, medium armour.

Guest room

The guest room is very dark as the only window is covered with a bed sheet. The window is broken, and the sheet occasionally moves with the outside wind letting a few rays of light inside. The characters without darkvision can only see the outline of the window. A musty smell permeates the surroundings, and everything is covered in a thick layer of dust. The room is filled with random pieces of furniture and equipment (chairs, lantern, a coil of heavy rope, crates, cartwheel, etc), rendering the room a difficult terrain (player movement is halved).

In the corner is a small armour stand with a **full plate amour**. In the middle of the chest plate is the Cornucopia (horn of plenty), a symbol of the halfling deity Yondalla.

As the players approach the middle of the room or try to remove the sheet from the window, they are ambushed by **two Spiders** (use stat blocks for Giant Spider, Basic Rules pg. 136), which lower themselves from the ceiling.

The door is unlocked and leads to the hallway. From the hall, there is access to the Kids' room (locked with a latch), the Ordurk's bedroom (locked, key required), the Guest room and a staircase.

Hallway

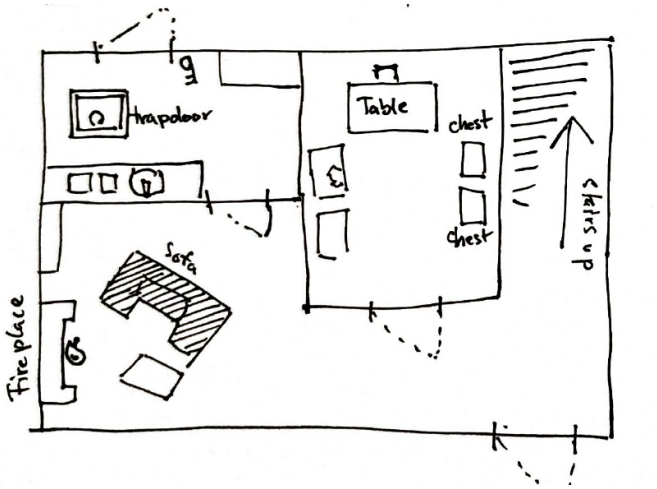
The hallway has a few paintings of different adventuring parties led by Ordurk through the years. There are short descriptions under the paintings:

- "Daring Company and defeat of the Lich King Szass Tam" - Ordurk stands in the middle holding a grinning skull. Next to him stands a dark elf woman with a hand over his shoulder.
- "….. " Ordurk with an enormous battle axe on his shoulder, some bearded wizard with a pipe and big red hat, dwarven women and a bald human with face tattoo stand in front of a corpse of a beholder.

Staircase

The staircase is trapped. The trap can be found with an investigation/perception check with DC 15 and disarmed with DC 10. If a trap is triggered, an enormous battle axe (depicted in the painting) swings from the ceiling at the height of an adult person (good 20 inches above the players' heads). At the bottom of the stairs is a Living room.

First floor



Living room

The living room is the largest room on the first floor. A front door is currently locked and cannot be opened. All windows on the first floor are barred with heavy iron bars. From the living room, a kitchen can be entered. Next to the kitchen is a door to the Ordark's study.

In the middle of the living room is a broken coffee table; next to it is a toppled armchair, torn Ordark's shirt with a little bit of blood and Ordark's belt can be found under the sofa. Kids never saw Ordark without his favourite belt, even though it had no effect on him. Next to the sofa, a dagger with a jagged obsidian blade with a silver spider on the handle (history check: it is related to drow) is sticking from the floor.

Obsidian dagger

Wondrous item, rare

Dagger + 1. If thrown, it will return to the owner's hand at the start of the next round.

Ordark's belt

Wondrous item, rare

While wearing this belt, your Strength score changes to 20. If your Strength is already equal to or greater than the belt's score.

Above the lit fireplace with iron bars, the Kraken's maw is hanged. The fire is slow and steady. The fireplace has four symbols on it: Sun, Waves, Cloud and Mountain. As illustrated in the picture book in the Kids' room, when someone presses symbols in the correct order (Waves, Mountain, Cloud, Sun), the bars open and **Minor Fire Elemental** is released (see Appendix for stat

block). After the elemental is defeated, a small **copper key** is visible on the back wall of the fireplace. On the fireplace mantle is a decorative **Silver Dagger** (which can be used as a "silvered longsword + 1").

Kitchen

The kitchen is separated from the living room by a half door. The bottom part of the door is locked and cannot be easily unlocked, but the inside of the kitchen is visible from the living room. Players can scale the bottom part and access the kitchen with little effort.

Right now, pans and knives are magically flying around while making breakfast. With a sneak higher than 10, players can avoid attention when entering the kitchen. Otherwise, they will be mistaken for an intruder and attacked by a butter knife, a pan and a rolling pin.

Cutlery (knives, pans or rolling pin)

Tiny creature

Armor Class 13
Hit Points 15
Speed 20 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)

Multiattack: Makes two melee attacks.

Actions

Attack. Melee Weapon Attack: +2 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 3 (1d6) slashing/bludgeoning damage.

A locked door to the backyard is on the other side of the kitchen. Next to the door is a keychain with a **key to Ordark's study and a key to the basement**.

On the floor in the kitchen is a locked trapdoor that leads to the basement.

While searching the kitchen: **Chocolate bar, 2 Potions of healing, Cleaver (1d6+1 and +1 to hit)**.

Ordark's Study

It is a poorly lit room with nice, heavy furniture. In the middle is a desk with piles of paper. Most of them are letters starting with a name and address, but the rest is scribbled out. On the floor is a pile of crumpled letters that smell like Ordarks cologne. Behind the desk is a comfortable leather armchair and bookcase filled with various tomes. Otherwise, the room is filled with memorabilia: Golden Crown, Dragon tooth, . . .

On the left side are two aquariums. One of them is broken. In the other is a **grey cube with a golden key in the middle**. If disturbed or the players try to reach for the key, the cube attacks (see Gray Ooze, Basic Rules, pg. 338.).

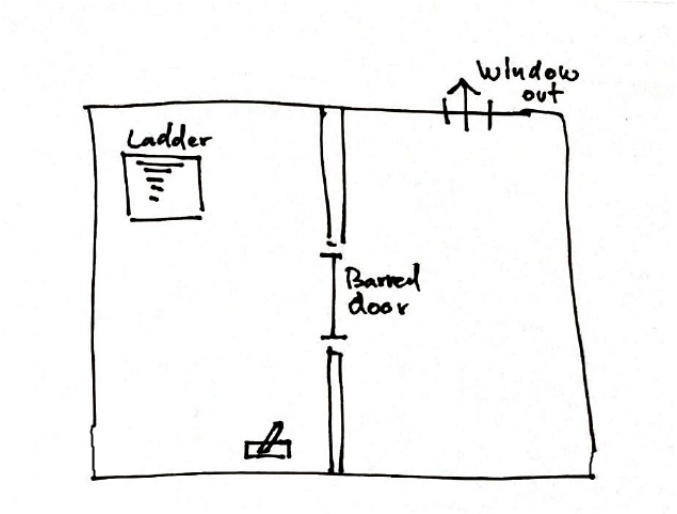
On the right side of the room are two identical chests with golden locks. One of the chests is a **mimic** (see Basic Rules, pg. 332) that escaped from the aquarium.

Next to the chests is a liquor cabinet with doors still open, and one bottle is broken in front of it. One bottle in the cabinet is different from the others. It is a bottle of Holy Water.

The golden key unlocks the actual chest, and inside is: **Bag of tricks** (see Basic Rules, 154), **Circlet of Blasting** (see Basic Rules, pg, 158), **Potion of healing**.

On the table is a small copper box (which can be unlocked with a copper key from the fireplace). There is a picture of Ordark with a Drow woman in a white dress inside the copper box. Next to the image is a ring made out of dark reddish metal.

Basement



The basement is cold, and the air is humid and stale. The basement is filled with barrels and bags with rations. On the other side is a barred door similar to a prison cell. Inside the cell are various crates and bags. Above them is a small, fully open window. The size is suitable for the players. The cell can be opened by pulling a chain. The chain is heavy, and all players must join in the effort.

As the barred door moves slightly, arcane marks appear on the floor. They start to shine, crack and vanish with a sizzle. The door flies up on its own with a loud crash.

“Finally free! It’s been a long time since we talked, my dear FRIEND!” Resonates in the mind of all players. The voice is pleasant and sweet, and the overall demeanour is kind until it breaks into a screech.

With the flash of the light, one of the crates breaks open. Splinters of wood fly in all directions. Torches on the wall are ablaze, and the room is illuminated in the brightest light.

A skull draped in pale, dry tattooed skin flies in the air. Its white eyes covered in yellowish film start frantically searching the room. The jaw unhinges, and maniacal cackle resonates through the air and minds.

“What are YOU? Children! I have to thank thee from the depths of my existence! My little saviours! Of course, I shall be eternally magnanimous and grant you the greatest gift of all. I will undo your PITIFUL existence! ” For stat block, see Appendix.

After defeating the head of the lich, Players can climb out the window and access the garden.

Chapter 3: Outside the house

After players climb out of the window, they can feel fresh morning air and dew on the grass. The sun slowly rises above the skyline, flowers turn their heads to it, and birds start singing. Players can hear soft female laughter from the gazebo in the middle of the garden, followed by deep, growling chuckles.

When they approached the gazebo, they found Ordark lying in the arms of Taraly. She is feeding him grapes and whispering in his ear. When he notices the kids, he springs and runs towards them.

"My dear, children! What happened?!" and immediately starts to cast healing spells. Taraly quickly joins him and starts to clean wounds and hug the kids.

"I am so sorry, my little... brave warriors!" Ordark says, pushing his tears back with the back of his hand, "I shouldn't have left you there alone and kept all that dangerous garbage in the house. I am throwing it all away today!".

Ordark introduces Taraly and tells the kids they are back together, and she will help him take care of them.

Chapter 4: Appendix

Minor Fire Elemental

Medium creature

Armor Class 10
Hit Points 50
Speed 50 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
12 (+1)	10 (+0)	5 (-3)	10 (+0)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)

Damage Resistances: Bludgeoning, Piercing, and Slashing from Nonmagical Attacks
Damage Immunities Fire, Poison
Condition Immunities: Exhaustion, Grappled, Paralyzed, Petrified, Poisoned, Prone, Restrained, Unconscious
Senses Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 10
Languages: Ignan, Common
Challenge: 3
Illumination. The elemental sheds bright light in a 30-foot radius and dim light in an additional 30 feet.
Water Susceptibility. Every gallon of water splashed, Minor Fire Elemental takes 3d6 cold damage. Fiery presence, any creature that ends its turn within 5ft of Minor Fire Elemental takes 1d4 of fire damage.

Actions

Multiattack. The elemental makes two touch attacks.

Touch. Melee Weapon Attack: +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. Hit: 6 (1d6 + 3) fire damage.

Head of Szass Tam

Tiny Undead, Lawful Evil

Armor Class 13
Hit Points 40 (10d4+20)
Speed 0 ft., fly 40 ft (hover)

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
1 (-5)	17 (+3)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)	10 (+0)	11 (+0)

Skills. Either Arcana + 4, Perception+2
Senses Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 12 **Languages.** All
Proficiency Bonus +2 **Damage Resistances** Lightning, Necrotic, Piercing, Fire
Damage Immunities Cold, Poison
Condition Immunities Charmed, Frightened, Paralyzed, Poisoned, Prone
Challenge 4

Legendary resistance: Once per combat Szass Tam can use its Legendary resistance to automatical succeed in a saving throw.

Rejuvenation. If the Skull of Szass Tam is destroyed but not sprinkled with holy water, it regains all its hit points in 1 hour.

Spellcasting. The Skull of Szass Tam is a 5th-level spellcaster. Its spellcasting ability is Intelligence (spell save DC 13, +5 to hit with spell attacks). It requires no somatic or material components to cast its spells. The Skull of Szass Tam has the following spells prepared:

Cantrips (at will): *firebolt*, *message*
1st level (3 slots): *magic missile*, *shield*
2nd level (2 slots): *shatter*, *flaming sphere*
3rd level (1 slot): *fear*

Actions

Multiattack. The Skull of Szass Tam makes two ranged spell attacks.

Firebolt.. Ranged Spell Attack: +5 to hit, range 30 ft., one target. Hit: 5 (1d10) fire damage.